

upcoming N97, run on an upgraded version of the platform: the S60 5th edition. Not many applications have been programmed for the latter yet, so unless it is specifically mentioned, assume that the Symbian programs mentioned in the upcoming pages may not work on these newer devices.

Windows Mobile, of course, is a ubiquitous platform. Right now, version 6.1 is the most common iteration, with it being loaded on almost all the new smart phones, right from the HTC Touch and its many variants to the Sony Ericsson Xperia. With its immense popularity on smart phones, this is the most widely used platform for high-end phones – especially touchscreen ones – and hence features prominently in the upcoming pages.

Also, just to clarify, there used to be a differentiation made between smartphones and pocket PCs till a few years back. The former were basically full-fledged phones with a keypad, while the latter sported touchscreen displays that had to be operated with a stylus. This was especially common before Palm's fall from its position as a heavyweight player in the industry (although with the Palm Pre and the WebOS, we might just see a resurrection; again, more on this in 'What's Next'). But over the past few years, the lines between the two genres have blurred and the term 'pocket PC' has died out. 'Smart phone' is now the common term for any mobile phone that offers PC-like functionality.

This wide variety of operating systems makes a compilation of smart phone software a bit difficult. While we would like to include essential software for each platform, it is simply not possible given editorial constraints. By and large, we have tried to give a solution that works across many platforms; but there were some OS-specific programs that we found very difficult to ignore and just had to put them in. We hope that we have covered most of the software you will need on your platform.

Armed with all this knowledge of operating systems, you are ready to flip to the next few pages of essential smart phone software; that is, if you already know what OS your phone is running on. If you do, then there is no reason to stick around here, and you can safely skip the next few paragraphs. However, if you are unclear about which platform's software works for you, it might be best to read on.